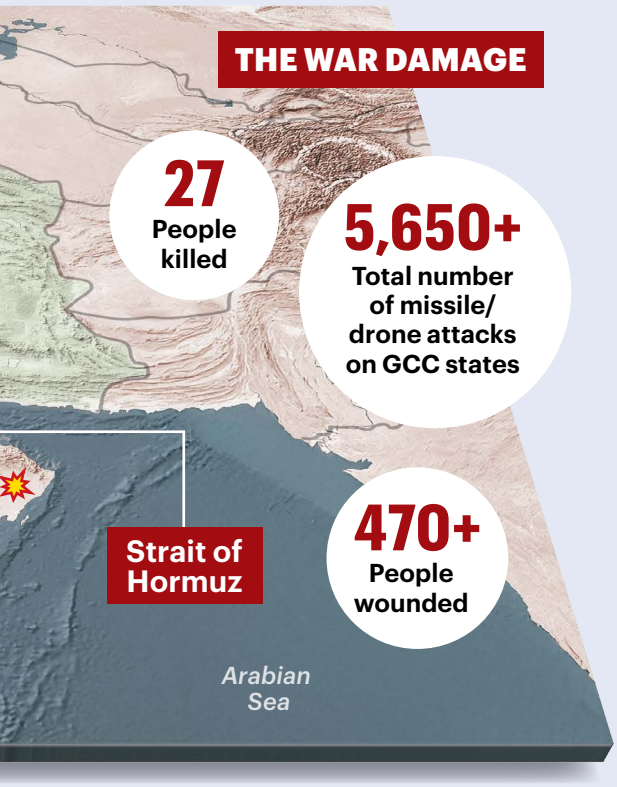


THE WAR DAMAGE



AVIATION TURMOIL

2,000
Number of daily flights handled by the five major Gulf airlines—Emirates, Qatar Airways, Flydubai, Air Arabia and Etihad Airways—before the war

$1.42 billion
Estimated **weekly losses** for the same five airlines since the war began, as **50 per cent of the flights have been cancelled**, jet fuel prices soar and planes take longer routes



FORLORN PATH
A runway at the Dubai International Airport

ALAMY

PINCHED PURSE

$200 billion
Loss of GDP value in GCC countries due to the war



2 million
Estimated number of **job losses** in the six nations

INDIANS IN THE GULF

9.9 billion
Number of expatriate Indians in Gulf countries

$51.5 billion
(₹4.7 lakh crore)
Total remittances to India from GCC countries

THE TOLL

8 Indians killed

1 Indian missing in the war

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

aortic valve of the global economy, through which passes nearly 25 per cent of the world's crude oil and 20 per cent of its liquefied natural gas, along with fertilisers, aluminium and other critical industrial inputs. The shock waves were immediate and global: crude prices surged, supply chains convulsed and mounting economic pressure pushed major powers to urge Washington to end a war that Trump launched without broad international backing even from America's North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO) allies.

Iran's other successful ploy was dragging the Gulf into the war, by accusing these regional states of allowing the use of their territory for US military operations. Indeed, the US has, over decades, embedded itself across the GCC through an extensive military ecosystem comprising eight major bases, airfields, naval hubs and logistics corridors supported by more than 35,000 American troops. As tensions spiralled, Iran widened the arc of conflict by moving beyond US-linked assets to strike oil infrastructure and, increasingly, civilian targets in the Gulf, turning the region into a high-risk frontline.

THE PRICE OF WAR

The economic toll has been brutal. The Gulf could be staring at losses exceeding $200 billion (Rs 18.5 lakh crore) from infrastructure damage, lost oil and gas revenue, disrupted trade and stalled investments. Growth forecasts across GCC economies have been slashed by 3.1 percentage points, from pre-war projections of 4.4 per cent. But the deeper cost lies beyond the numbers. This was a region in the midst of a historic pivot. Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Qatar and Oman were racing to reduce their dependence on hydrocarbons and reinvent themselves as global hubs across aviation, tourism, logistics and services. The war has shaken these very pillars of the economy, fundamentally eroding the